Case Study on the Limitations of Low-Code Platforms

Project: Job Application Management System using Zoho Creator

Aim

To analyse the limitations of using a low-code platform such as Zoho Creator for the Job Application Management System, especially as application volume, integrations, customization, security requirements, and reporting needs increase.

Introduction

Zoho Creator supports rapid development of forms, workflows, reports, and dashboards with visual tools and Deluge scripting. It is suitable for an initial job application system that stores candidate details, resumes, skills, experience, job roles, and expected salary. As the system grows to support many recruiters, large numbers of applications, advanced screening, and multiple external services, platform limits and governance requirements must be considered.

Project Scenario

A recruitment organization uses the Job Application Management System to collect applications, review candidate profiles, track job roles, and analyse expected salary and application counts. In a larger deployment, it may need to handle a high volume of applications, resume parsing, automated notifications, integration with job portals, and strict protection of personal data.

Key Limitations

1. Scalability and Performance As the number of applications and resumes grows, large reports and repeated record retrieval may become slower. API, storage, and script-execution limits depend on the platform plan.

2. Customisation Constraints The visual form and report builders support common recruitment workflows, but unusual recruiter interfaces, advanced ranking algorithms, or specialized screening logic may require custom code or external services.

3. Vendor Lock-in Forms, workflows, data structures, and Deluge scripts are tied to Zoho Creator. Moving to another platform may require rebuilding application logic and adapting exported data.

4. Integration Complexity Connecting job portals, email services, resume parsing tools, calendars, or external HR systems may depend on API availability, connector support, authentication, and connection limits.

5. Complex Business Logic Advanced candidate matching, large-scale resume analysis, ranking models, and multi-stage recruitment rules can exceed what is convenient to implement entirely in low-code workflows.

6. Security and Compliance The system contains personal information such as names, contact details, resumes, work experience, and expected salary. Access controls and sharing settings must be configured carefully, while infrastructure-level controls remain dependent on the provider.

7. Testing and Deployment Automated testing, source control, release pipelines, and debugging options may be more limited than in a fully custom software stack. Each workflow and permission change needs careful testing.

8. Governance and Maintainability Quick changes made without documentation can create duplicate fields, inconsistent reports, and difficult-to-maintain workflows. Clear ownership and change records are important.

9. Cost at Scale As more recruiters or administrators need access, subscription costs, higher limits, environments, or add-ons may affect the total cost.

10. AI and Advanced Screening Sentiment analysis, resume extraction, or AI-assisted screening may depend on plan availability and feature limits. AI output also needs human review and should not be the sole basis for hiring decisions.

Low-Code vs Pro-Code for This Project

Aspect	Zoho Creator / Low-Code	Pro-Code System
Development speed	Fast creation of forms, workflows and reports.	Usually requires more development time.
Customization	Best for common recruitment processes.	Greater control over interfaces and algorithms.
Scale	Bounded by plan and platform limits.	Can be designed for larger workloads with suitable architecture.
Maintenance	Provider manages underlying infrastructure.	Development team manages infrastructure and updates.
Portability	Platform-specific data and scripts can increase migration effort.	Can offer more control over data formats and deployment choices.

Mitigation Strategies

1. Use Zoho Creator for candidate forms, recruiter workflows, and operational dashboards while moving specialized high-volume processing to external services when needed.

2. Design the application data model carefully and use filtered reports rather than repeatedly retrieving all records.

3. Test API, storage, script, and connection limits early with representative sample data.

4. Apply least-privilege permissions and keep resumes and candidate contact information private.

5. Document fields, workflows, report definitions, and changes so the application remains maintainable.

6. Keep data exports and plan a migration path in case the recruitment system outgrows the platform.

7. Treat AI-based screening as decision support, validate its output, and retain human review.

Conclusion

Zoho Creator is a practical choice for developing the initial Job Application Management System because it supports quick form creation, workflow automation, and dashboard reporting. If the system expands to large application volumes, complex candidate matching, extensive third-party integrations, or stricter governance needs, a hybrid approach combining low-code workflows with dedicated services may be more suitable. The appropriate design depends on measured workload, subscription limits, security requirements, and future growth.